

noisseur of wines and in tobacco, too, his taste was aware of equally subtle gradations. He smoked only the tobacco of certain favored crop years. It was Havana tobacco, but it was rolled in shapes never sold in any cigar store. Morgan cigars had the form of a Hercules club, bulging thickly at the outer end, and they were absolutely poisonous for all but the most experienced smokers. I know I smoked myself giddy the first time I lighted one that he had thrust into my hand. Thereafter, until I had become inured to strong tobacco, I would always put his gift cigars in my pocket, and so keep my mind free for the calm consideration of whatever financial matter we might be under the necessity of discussing. On this night to which I refer, Mr. Morgan was listening as a report was made on the contents of the portfolio of the bank we were considering. That astonishing brain of his would take into itself a welter of facts and then, after consideration, he would speak, and we who listened would know that we were hearing wisdom. Suddenly I saw that the hand holding his cigar had relaxed on the table; his head had sunk forward until his chin was cushioned on his cravat. His breathing had become audible. The weary old man had fallen asleep.

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*One of the early features of the panic had been the discrediting of individuals who had come to occupy important positions in the banking structure.*

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Some one there, with a touch on the arm, silenced the one who was talking; another reached forward and lifted from the relaxed fingers, as one might take a rattle from a baby, the big cigar that was scorching the varnish of the table. Then we sat quietly, saying nothing whatever. One who went for a drink of water walked on tiptoes. The only sound that could be heard was the breathing of Mr. Morgan. It seems to me now that it was a long while before he awak-